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Representation of a smart home (www.which.co.uk)

ing family and friends for immediate attention.

Smart security systems. Security systems include facial recognition, motion detection, voice recognition and biometric access control.

Facial recognition. Smart home devices include Wi-Fi-enabled devices with video feed security features. You can remotely access these features on a smartphone from any location. Smart systems incorporate facial recognition technology into connected video cameras. AI-based neural networks can identify eyes, cheekbones, nose and chin of a visitor through the relevant camera and compare with the faces of the home's residents and send notifications about suspicious activity to the home-owner's smartphone.

Motion detection. Motion sensors can detect random movement through video surveillance like detecting intruders and warning home-owners.

Biometric access control. Biometric door locks such as August Smart Lock can be seamlessly integrated into Amazon and Google smart home systems. These usually take photos of the user's fingertips via optical scanners and store them for matching, or use two-factor authentication using fingerprints and passwords.

Voice recognition. AI-based voice recognition employs Natural Language Processing (NLP). This technology isolates a person's voice from background noises, converts the audio to a digital file, sends it to the cloud for

NLP analysis and triggers an appropriate action. With machine learning, it is possible to teach a system to recognise a variety of different terms or messages.

The term voice recognition or speaker identification refers to identifying the speaker rather than meaning of the voice or interpretation. It can be trained on a specific person's voice, or used to authenticate or verify the identity of the speaker as part of a security process.

Optimising energy consumption. Smart home automation products provide functionality beyond controlling devices or notifying warning signals—these also optimise energy performance. With integration of AI and machine learning, smart devices offer energy consumption patterns to help users limit the usage of devices and appliances when not required.

Energy saving and efficiency are hot topics due to climate changes and energy challenges globally. AI-powered smart devices can reduce the carbon footprints by controlling many home automation systems including smart thermostats, smart plugs and automated lighting sensors.

Challenges in smart home systems

While there are many benefits of smart home devices, there are also challenges to fully implement a truly smart home system. This is because, to set up a secure, scalable and highly func-